

The Lady, or the Tiger?

Frank R. Stockton · 1882

First published: The Century, Nov 1882

TEACHER EDITION · CURRICULUM UNIT

One 90-minute lesson (the whole story), with an optional take-home essay

Syllabus · 90-minute lesson plans · lecture scripts · vocabulary · quizzes with keys · writing prompts at eleven rigor levels · SAT-style items · whole-book test · essays

Liber et Libri · Lux et Libri LLC

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Contents and unit overview

1. Unit overview and the 90-minute lesson
2. Syllabus (weekly pacing)
3. Lesson plans and lecture scripts (chapters 1–1), each with vocabulary, discussion questions, annotation focus, quiz and key, writing prompts and SAT-style items
4. Whole-book test and answer key
5. Essay assignments at eleven rigor levels

Edition: Reading text: https://en.wikisource.org/wiki/The_lady,_or_the_tiger?_and_other_stories/The_Lady,_or_the_Tiger? (revision 5766637), cleaned for Liber et Libri.

Grades: Grades 6–10 (scales to graduate via rigor levels). Short story: read whole in one 90-minute lesson (assign longer stories as pre-reading). Middle School prompts use the full text when the grade tags include 6–8; otherwise teacher-selected passages. **Weeks:** 1. **Class days:** 1 × 90 minutes (1 chapter lessons plus seminar, test and essay days).

Essential questions

- What does The Lady, or the Tiger? suggest about jealousy and love?
- What does The Lady, or the Tiger? suggest about justice and chance?
- What does The Lady, or the Tiger? suggest about choice?

Objectives

- Cite textual evidence to support analysis of what the text says explicitly and implicitly.
- Determine themes and analyze their development over the course of the story.
- Analyze how characters, setting and point of view interact.
- Determine the meaning of words and phrases as they are used in the text.
- Write arguments to support claims with clear reasons and relevant evidence.

Standards and frameworks

- **Common Core:** RL.7.2, RL.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2, RL.9-10.3, RL.9-10.4, RL.9-10.5, RL.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2, RL.11-12.4, RL.11-12.5, W.7.1, W.9-10.1, W.11-12.1, L.9-10.4, L.11-12.4
  Common Core State Standards (ELA-Literacy), thecorestandards.org
- **Indiana 2023:** 7.RC.2, 7.RC.3, 7.W.1, 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.RC.2, 9-10.RC.3, 9-10.RC.9, 9-10.RC.12, 9-10.W.1, 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.RC.4, 11-12.RC.11, 11-12.RC.13, 11-12.W.1
  Indiana Academic Standards, English/Language Arts (2023), IDOE

- **Dual Credit (Indiana College Core):** ICC-WC-1.1, ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.4, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.7
  Indiana College Core, Written Communication outcomes 1.1–1.7 (CHE guidance); ICC-WC-x IDs are ours
- **AP:** AP-LIT.CHR, AP-LIT.SET, AP-LIT.STR, AP-LIT.NAR, AP-LIT.FIG, AP-LIT.LAN
  AP English Literature and Composition big ideas (our summaries; apcentral.collegeboard.org)
- **Cambridge International:** CAIE-9695.AO1, CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO4, CAIE-9695.AO5
  Cambridge International AS & A Level Literature in English 9695 assessment objectives (our summaries; cambridgeinternational.org)
- **Liber et Libri program outcomes:** LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-GR-LIT-1
  Liber et Libri program outcome, not an official standard

Primary codes: RL.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2, RL.9-10.3, RL.9-10.4, RL.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2, RL.11-12.5, W.9-10.1, W.11-12.1, RL.7.2
Assessments: Daily story quizzes (auto-graded); Weekly writing prompt (rubric); Socratic seminars (scheduled days); Whole-story test (scheduled day); Final essay (scheduled day); College Sophomore and above write one essay of the five
Differentiation: Every prompt and quiz has eleven rigor levels (Middle School through Graduate / PhD); the app applies student override, then class standard, then the automatic level. Each prompt is tagged for Common Core, Indiana 2023, Dual Credit (Indiana College Core), AP and Cambridge where they apply.
Materials: Liber et Libri reader; Annotation journal; Story lecture slides or script

The 90-minute lesson

#	Segment	Mode	Minutes	Clock
1	Bell-ringer	You do	8	0–8
2	Vocabulary with etymology notes	I do	10	8–18
3	Background and context	I do	10	18–28
4	I do: modeled close reading	I do	12	28–40
5	We do: guided annotation	We do	15	40–55
6	You do: independent annotation	You do	15	55–70
7	Discussion	We do	10	70–80
8	Exit ticket / chapter quiz	You do	7	80–87
9	Closure	I do	3	87–90
	Total		**90**	

Syllabus

Week	Chapters	Lessons	Focus and activities	Assessment
1	The Lady, or the Tiger?	1 × 90 min (90 min)	*jealousy and love* • Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and word histories, background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure • Story quizzes in the app • Writing prompt at assigned rigor (one graded per week)	Quiz average plus one graded writing prompt

Lesson plans and lecture scripts

Each chapter is one 90-minute class. Scripts are a starting point; adapt them to your students. Teacher summaries contain spoilers.

Lesson 1: The Lady, or the Tiger?

Focus: a choice the reader must make

Content note (implied violent death): Sensitive content: Implied violent death. Preview the story, tell students in advance, and allow a pass on reading aloud. Keep discussion on how the writer uses these elements, not on graphic detail.
Student preview: Heads-up: this story includes implied violent death.
Suggested language: "Why does the writer include this, and what does it make us notice?"

Teacher only · spoilers

A semi-barbaric king judges the accused in an arena: the accused opens one of two doors, behind one a tiger, behind the other a lady he must marry. When the princess's lowborn lover is caught, she learns which door hides which. She signals him to the right-hand door. The story ends without telling us what came out.

Background: Published in The Century in 1882 and widely debated; Stockton reportedly never answered.

Significance: The most famous open ending in American fiction; on Glencoe grade 9 lesson plans.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Respond in writing to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Settle in and write for five minutes: Would you rather someone you love be happy with someone else, or lose them forever? No wrong answers yet; we will test these ideas against the text. Two volunteers share, and I note key words on the board. Before we start, a content note: Heads-up: this story includes implied violent death.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Introduce 5 key words: pronounce, define from context, then the word's history.
Today's words are exuberant, devious, gnashed, amphitheatre, fateful. For each one we read the sentence, guess from context and then check the definition. Here is the first: "He was a man of exuberant fancy, and, withal, of an authority so irresistible that, at his will, he turned his varied fancies into facts." In this sentence it means: joyously unrestrained. Word histories: For the other words, look up the word history (Etymonline or the OED) and record the language of origin and the root meaning in your etymology log.

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Present the historical and literary background.
Here is what the first readers of The Lady, or the Tiger? would have known. Published in The Century in 1882 and widely debated; Stockton reportedly never answered. Why does this story matter? The most famous open ending in American fiction; on Glencoe grade 9 lesson plans. Write down one question you want answered.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Teacher models a think-aloud on the anchor passage for structure.
Watch me read this the way a careful reader does. The passage opens: "But even here the exuberant and barbaric fancy asserted itself." I stop and ask: what is the author doing here, and how does it connect to a choice the reader must make? I circle "exuberant", one of today's words, and ask why the author chose it over a plainer word. When I find structure, I underline it and write its effect in the margin, then I check my idea against the next sentence.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Read the anchor passage aloud together; annotate for structure.
Now we do it together. I read the first sentence and you track along. Mark every example of structure. Turn to a partner: what does the author want us to notice? I will collect three ideas and we choose the strongest using evidence.

> *But even here the exuberant and barbaric fancy asserted itself. The arena of the king was built, not to give the people an opportunity of hearing the rhapsodies of dying gladiators, nor to enable them to view the inevitable conclusion of a conflict between religious opinions and hungry jaws, but for purposes far better adapted to widen and develop the mental energies of the people. This vast amphitheatre, with its encircling galleries, its mysterious vaults, and its unseen passages, was an agent of poetic justice, in which crime was punished, or virtue rewarded, by the decrees of an impartial and incorruptible chance.*

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Students annotate a new passage independently in the reader, then begin the writing prompt at their assigned rigor level.
Your turn. Annotate the next page in the app for Structure, Irony, Characterization: at least three marks with a margin note each. Then open your writing prompt; the app shows the level your teacher assigned (for a 9–10 class, the HS Sophomore prompt reads: Analyze how The Lady, or the Tiger? develops the idea of a choice the reader must make. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of structure and irony shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) I will circulate and conference.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions (focus set for the class level): wait time, think-pair-share on DOK 3/4, follow-up probes.
Let's talk. We move from what happens to why it matters to whether it's right. After each question I wait before calling on anyone: think first. Our anchor question: How does this story connect to jealousy and love? Every claim needs a page reference. Respond to the person before you by agreeing, extending or challenging with evidence, and end by writing one question of your own.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Story quiz in the app, then a one-sentence exit ticket.
Take the story quiz in the app. Then, in one sentence, tell me what this story suggests about a choice the reader must make, backed by one short quotation.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how structure shapes a choice the reader must make. Tonight, read the next story and add two words to your etymology log.

Total: 90 minutes.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
exuberant (adjective)	joyously unrestrained	*He was a man of exuberant fancy, and, withal, of an authority so irresistible that, at his will, he turned his varied fancies into facts.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
devious (adjective)	indirect in departing from the accepted or proper way; misleading	*It involves a study of the human heart which leads us through devious mazes of passion, out of which it is difficult to find our way.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
gnashed (verb)	grind together, of teeth	*How in her grievous reveries had she gnashed her teeth, and torn her hair, when she saw his start of rapturous delight as he opened the door of the lady!*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
amphitheatre (noun)	a sloping gallery with seats for spectators (as in an operating room or theater)	*This vast amphitheatre, with its encircling galleries, its mysterious vaults, and its unseen passages, was an agent of poetic justice, in which crime was punished, or virtue rewarded, by the decrees of an impartial and incorruptible chance.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
fateful (adjective)	decided by fate; leading to an unhappy end	*The king and his court were in their places, opposite the twin doors,—those fateful portals, so terrible in their similarity.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
rewarded (verb)	given something good in return	*This vast amphitheatre, with its encircling galleries, its mysterious vaults, and its unseen passages, was an agent of poetic justice, in which crime was punished, or virtue rewarded, by the decrees of an impartial and incorruptible chance.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
premises (noun)	assumptions an argument is based on	*He did not hesitate nor waver in regard to his duty in the premises.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
depended (verb)	be contingent upon (something that is elided)	*Think of it, fair reader, not as if the decision of the question depended upon yourself, but upon that hot-blooded, semi-barbaric princess, her soul at a white heat beneath the combined fires of despair and jealousy.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
hesitate (verb)	pause or hold back in uncertainty or unwillingness	*He did not hesitate nor waver in regard to his duty in the premises.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

Discussion questions

1. Would you rather someone you love be happy with someone else, or lose them forever?
2. Where does structure appear in this story, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this story connect to the book's larger concern with jealousy and love?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. How does the king's arena decide guilt? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: The accused opens one of two doors
2. What is behind the two doors? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: A tiger and a lady
3. Why is the princess's lover on trial? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: He loved the king's daughter
4. Which door does the princess point to? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: The right-hand door
5. How does the story end? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: It asks the reader which came out
6. Retell the three most important events of “The Lady, or the Tiger?” in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: A semi-barbaric king judges the accused in an arena: the accused opens one of two doors, behind one a tiger, behind the other a lady he must marry. When the princess's lowborn lover is caught, she learns which door hides which. She signals him to the right-hand door. The story ends without telling us what came out.
7. Which characters appear or are mentioned in “The Lady, or the Tiger?”? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the story; check against the teacher summary.
8. Where and when does “The Lady, or the Tiger?” take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the story.
9. Reread: “He was a man of exuberant fancy, and, withal, of an authority so irresistible that, at his will, he turned his varied fancies into facts.” What does “exuberant” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: exuberant: joyously unrestrained.
10. Reread: “It involves a study of the human heart which leads us through devious mazes of passion, out of which it is difficult to find our way.” What does “devious” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: devious: indirect in departing from the accepted or proper way; misleading.

Inferential / analytical

1. What does “The Lady, or the Tiger?” suggest about a choice the reader must make? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2] Look for: The most famous open ending in American fiction; on Glencoe grade 9 lesson plans.
2. Find one example of structure in this story. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2] Look for: Look for how the story is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does.
3. How does the irony in this story shape what we understand about a choice the reader must make? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.6, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.2] Look for: Look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true.
4. In the passage that begins “But even here the exuberant and barbaric fancy asserted itself.”, why might Stockton have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, 7.RC.12, 7.CC.2] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
5. What causes the main turn in “The Lady, or the Tiger?”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2] Look for: A semi-barbaric king judges the accused in an arena: the accused opens one of two doors, behind one a tiger, behind the other a lady he must marry. When the princess's lowborn lover is caught, she learns which door hides which. She signals him to the right-hand door. The story ends without telling…
6. As the opening story, what does “The Lady, or the Tiger?” set up that the rest of The Lady, or the Tiger? will need? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous story.
7. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
8. The bell-ringer asked: “Would you rather someone you love be happy with someone else, or lose them forever?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
9. Where does characterization appear, and how does it connect this story to the larger concern with jealousy and love? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
10. Background: Published in The Century in 1882 and widely debated; Stockton reportedly never answered. How does knowing this change the way you read one moment in the story? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2] Look for: A specific moment reread in light of the context.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. A critic might argue: “The most famous open ending in American fiction; on Glencoe grade 9 lesson plans.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the story. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
2. Which character in this story acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

3. Rewrite one moment of "The Lady, or the Tiger?" from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about a choice the reader must make? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.6, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.3] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
4. Write three questions of your own about "The Lady, or the Tiger?": one recall, one "why/how", and one "should/what if". Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.
5. Connect this story to justice and chance: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Stockton need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.
6. Is the structure in this story effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.
7. Compare how "The Lady, or the Tiger?" treats a choice the reader must make with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does The Lady, or the Tiger? see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.
8. As the final story, does this ending resolve jealousy and love? Argue whether the ending is earned. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
9. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this story (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about a choice the reader must make? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
10. What question would you most like to ask Frank R. Stockton about this story, and what answer do you think the text itself gives? [DOK 4 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: A student-generated question answered from evidence.

Annotation focus

- **Structure:** look for how the story is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Irony**: gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them

Chapter quiz

1. How does the king's arena decide guilt?
   A. A jury votes
   B. The accused opens one of two doors
   C. The king decides
   D. A duel
2. What is behind the two doors?
   A. Two tigers
   B. Gold and a sword
   C. A tiger and a lady
   D. A prison and freedom

3. Why is the princess's lover on trial?
   A. He loved the king's daughter
   B. He stole from the king
   C. He killed a guard
   D. He insulted the king
4. Which door does the princess point to?
   A. The right-hand door
   B. Both
   C. The left-hand door
   D. Neither
5. How does the story end?
   A. The lover marries the lady
   B. The princess frees him
   C. The tiger kills him
   D. It asks the reader which came out
6. In the line “He was a man of exuberant fancy, and, withal, of an authority so irresistible that, at his will, he turned his varied fancies into facts.”, what does “exuberant” most nearly mean?
   A. joyously unrestrained
   B. grind together, of teeth
   C. indirect in departing from the accepted or proper way; misleading
   D. a sloping gallery with seats for spectators (as in an operating room or theater)
7. In the line “It involves a study of the human heart which leads us through devious mazes of passion, out of which it is difficult to find our way.”, what does “devious” most nearly mean?
   A. grind together, of teeth
   B. indirect in departing from the accepted or proper way; misleading
   C. a sloping gallery with seats for spectators (as in an operating room or theater)
   D. joyously unrestrained

Answer key: 1. B (The accused opens one of two doors); 2. C (A tiger and a lady); 3. A (He loved the king's daughter); 4. A (The right-hand door); 5. D (It asks the reader which came out); 6. A (joyously unrestrained); 7. B (indirect in departing from the accepted or proper way; misleading)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.3, W.7.1; Indiana 2023: 7.RC.3, 7.W.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this story is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In “The Lady, or the Tiger?,” how does Stockton show a choice the reader must make? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the structure you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.5, W.9-10.1; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.3, 9-10.W.1): In The Lady, or the Tiger?, how does Stockton develop the idea of a choice the reader must make? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the structure in the story helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.5, W.9-10.1; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.3, 9-10.W.1): Analyze how The Lady, or the Tiger? develops the idea of a choice the reader must make. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of structure and irony shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO3): Analyze how the structure of The Lady, or the Tiger? (where it begins, turns and ends) and its structure shape the reader's understanding of a choice the reader must make. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5): Two readers disagree about what The Lady, or the Tiger? suggests about a choice the reader must make. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the story's structure and irony), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; AP: AP-LIT.STR, AP-LIT.LAN; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO4): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Frank R. Stockton uses structure in The Lady, or the Tiger? to complicate the reader's understanding of a choice the reader must make. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate The Lady, or the Tiger? within its historical and literary context and argue how the story's treatment of a choice the reader must make responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read The Lady, or the Tiger? alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the story's handling of a choice the reader must make follows or bends those conventions, using the structure as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to The Lady, or the Tiger? and its treatment of a choice the reader must make. State your method, show what it reveals in the story's structure and irony, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads The Lady, or the Tiger? as evidence for a larger claim about a choice the reader

must make in The Lady, or the Tiger?. Connect close reading of the story to the whole story, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads The Lady, or the Tiger? as a hinge in the story's larger treatment of a choice the reader must make. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on The Lady, or the Tiger?.

SAT-style questions

1. *How in her grievous reveries had she gnashed her teeth, and torn her hair, when she saw his start of rapturous delight as he opened the door of the lady!*

   As used in the text, what does the word “gnashed” most nearly mean?

   A. pause or hold back in uncertainty or unwillingness

   B. be contingent upon (something that is elided)

   C. grind together, of teeth

   D. assumptions an argument is based on

2. *But even here the exuberant and barbaric fancy asserted itself. The arena of the king was built, not to give the people an opportunity of hearing the rhapsodies of dying gladiators, nor to enable them to view the inevitable conclusion of a conflict between religious opinions and hungry jaws, but for purposes far better adapted to widen and develop the mental energies of the people. This vast amphitheatre, with its encircling galleries, its mysterious vaults, and its unseen passages, was an agent of poetic justice, in which crime was punished, or virtue rewarded, by the decrees of an impartial and incorruptible chance.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “The Lady, or the Tiger?”?

   A. The futile attempt to shut out death

   B. Hope created by an act of sacrifice

   C. A choice the reader must make

   D. Greed that grasps more than a person needs

SAT key: 1. C (grind together, of teeth); 2. C (A choice the reader must make)

Whole-book test

The Lady, or the Tiger?: whole-book test · 90 minutes

Part I: Multiple choice

1. How does the king's arena decide guilt?
   A. A jury votes
   B. The accused opens one of two doors
   C. The king decides
   D. A duel
2. What is behind the two doors?
   A. Two tigers
   B. Gold and a sword
   C. A tiger and a lady
   D. A prison and freedom
3. Why is the princess's lover on trial?
   A. He loved the king's daughter
   B. He stole from the king
   C. He killed a guard
   D. He insulted the king
4. Which door does the princess point to?
   A. The right-hand door
   B. Both
   C. The left-hand door
   D. Neither
5. How does the story end?
   A. The lover marries the lady
   B. The princess frees him
   C. The tiger kills him
   D. It asks the reader which came out
6. In the line “He was a man of exuberant fancy, and, withal, of an authority so irresistible that, at his will, he turned his varied fancies into facts.”, what does “exuberant” most nearly mean?
   A. joyously unrestrained
   B. grind together, of teeth
   C. indirect in departing from the accepted or proper way; misleading
   D. a sloping gallery with seats for spectators (as in an operating room or theater)

7. In the line “It involves a study of the human heart which leads us through devious mazes of passion, out of which it is difficult to find our way.”, what does “devious” most nearly mean?
   A. grind together, of teeth
   B. indirect in departing from the accepted or proper way; misleading
   C. a sloping gallery with seats for spectators (as in an operating room or theater)
   D. joyously unrestrained
8. As used in the story (“He was a man of exuberant fancy, and, withal, of an authority so irresistible that, at his will, he turned his varied fancies into facts.”), what does “exuberant” mean?
   A. joyously unrestrained
   B. decided by fate; leading to an unhappy end
   C. be contingent upon (something that is elided)
   D. grind together, of teeth
9. As used in the story (“It involves a study of the human heart which leads us through devious mazes of passion, out of which it is difficult to find our way.”), what does “devious” mean?
   A. given something good in return
   B. indirect in departing from the accepted or proper way; misleading
   C. pause or hold back in uncertainty or unwillingness
   D. a sloping gallery with seats for spectators (as in an operating room or theater)
10. As used in the story (“How in her grievous reveries had she gnashed her teeth, and torn her hair, when she saw his start of rapturous delight as he opened the door”), what does “gnashed” mean?
    A. assumptions an argument is based on
    B. joyously unrestrained
    C. grind together, of teeth
    D. decided by fate; leading to an unhappy end
11. As used in the story (“This vast amphitheatre, with its encircling galleries, its mysterious vaults, and its unseen passages, was an agent of poetic justice, in wh”), what does “amphitheatre” mean?
    A. be contingent upon (something that is elided)
    B. indirect in departing from the accepted or proper way; misleading
    C. given something good in return
    D. a sloping gallery with seats for spectators (as in an operating room or theater)
12. As used in the story (“The king and his court were in their places, opposite the twin doors,—those fateful portals, so terrible in their similarity.”), what does “fateful” mean?
    A. decided by fate; leading to an unhappy end
    B. pause or hold back in uncertainty or unwillingness
    C. grind together, of teeth
    D. assumptions an argument is based on

Part II: Short answer

1. Explain how jealousy and love develops from the beginning of the story to the end. Use two passages.

2. Explain how justice and chance develops from the beginning of the story to the end. Use two passages.
3. Explain how choice develops from the beginning of the story to the end. Use two passages.

Part III: Essay

Choose one of the story's central concerns (jealousy and love, justice and chance, choice) and argue how the ending reframes it.

Answer key

Answer key: 1. B (The accused opens one of two doors); 2. C (A tiger and a lady); 3. A (He loved the king's daughter); 4. A (The right-hand door); 5. D (It asks the reader which came out); 6. A (joyously unrestrained); 7. B (indirect in departing from the accepted or proper way; misleading); 8. A (joyously unrestrained); 9. B (indirect in departing from the accepted or proper way; misleading); 10. C (grind together, of teeth); 11. D (a sloping gallery with seats for spectators (as in an operating room or theater)); 12. A (decided by fate; leading to an unhappy end)

Essay assignments

Essay: Jealousy and love

Middle School (600 words; Common Core: W.7.1, RL.7.2; Indiana 2023: 7.W.1, 7.RC.2): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track): write a five-paragraph essay explaining what The Lady, or the Tiger? teaches about jealousy and love. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2; Indiana 2023: 9-10.W.1, 9-10.RC.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how Frank R. Stockton develops jealousy and love in The Lady, or the Tiger?. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2; Indiana 2023: 9-10.W.1, 9-10.RC.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how Frank R. Stockton develops jealousy and love across The Lady, or the Tiger?. Trace the idea through at least three parts of the story and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.5; Indiana 2023: 11-12.W.1, 11-12.RC.3; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of The Lady, or the Tiger? (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of jealousy and love. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2; Indiana 2023: 11-12.W.1, 11-12.RC.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO5): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of jealousy and love in The Lady, or the Tiger?. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; AP: AP-LIT.LAN; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2; Indiana 2023: 11-12.W.1, 11-12.RC.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO4): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how Frank R. Stockton's choices in The Lady, or the Tiger? (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of jealousy and love, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.4, ICC-WC-1.7): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places The Lady, or the Tiger?'s treatment of jealousy and love in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

College Sophomore (2200 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C2-W-1, LeL-C2-LIT-1): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on jealousy and love in The Lady, or the Tiger? that reads the story against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Junior (2800 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C3-W-1, LeL-C3-LIT-1): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on jealousy and love in The Lady, or the Tiger?. Name your critical

method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Senior (4000 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C4-W-1, LeL-C4-LIT-1): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about jealousy and love in The Lady, or the Tiger?, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Graduate / PhD (6000 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-GR-W-1, LeL-GR-LIT-1): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on jealousy and love in The Lady, or the Tiger?, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

Essay: Justice and chance

Middle School (600 words; Common Core: W.7.1, RL.7.2; Indiana 2023: 7.W.1, 7.RC.2): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track): write a five-paragraph essay explaining what The Lady, or the Tiger? teaches about justice and chance. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2; Indiana 2023: 9-10.W.1, 9-10.RC.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how Frank R. Stockton develops justice and chance in The Lady, or the Tiger?. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2; Indiana 2023: 9-10.W.1, 9-10.RC.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how Frank R. Stockton develops justice and chance across The Lady, or the Tiger?. Trace the idea through at least three parts of the story and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.5; Indiana 2023: 11-12.W.1, 11-12.RC.3; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of The Lady, or the Tiger? (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of justice and chance. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2; Indiana 2023: 11-12.W.1, 11-12.RC.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO5): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of justice and chance in The Lady, or the Tiger?. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; AP: AP-LIT.LAN; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2; Indiana 2023: 11-12.W.1, 11-12.RC.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO4): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how Frank R. Stockton's choices in The Lady, or the Tiger? (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of justice and chance, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.4, ICC-WC-1.7): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places The Lady, or the Tiger?'s treatment of justice and chance in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

College Sophomore (2200 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C2-W-1, LeL-C2-LIT-1): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on justice and chance in The Lady, or the Tiger? that reads the story against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Junior (2800 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C3-W-1, LeL-C3-LIT-1): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on justice and chance in The Lady, or the Tiger?. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Senior (4000 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C4-W-1, LeL-C4-LIT-1): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about justice and chance in The Lady, or the Tiger?, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Graduate / PhD (6000 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-GR-W-1, LeL-GR-LIT-1): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on justice and chance in The Lady, or the Tiger?, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

Essay: Choice

Middle School (600 words; Common Core: W.7.1, RL.7.2; Indiana 2023: 7.W.1, 7.RC.2): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track): write a five-paragraph essay explaining what The Lady, or the Tiger? teaches about choice. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2; Indiana 2023: 9-10.W.1, 9-10.RC.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how Frank R. Stockton develops choice in The Lady, or the Tiger?. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2; Indiana 2023: 9-10.W.1, 9-10.RC.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how Frank R. Stockton develops choice across The Lady, or the Tiger?. Trace the idea through at least three parts of the story and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.5; Indiana 2023: 11-12.W.1, 11-12.RC.3; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of The Lady, or the Tiger? (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of choice. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2; Indiana 2023: 11-12.W.1, 11-12.RC.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO5): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of choice in The Lady, or the Tiger?. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; AP: AP-LIT.LAN; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2; Indiana 2023: 11-12.W.1, 11-12.RC.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO4): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how Frank R. Stockton's choices in The Lady, or the Tiger? (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of choice, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.4, ICC-WC-1.7): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places The Lady, or the Tiger?'s treatment of choice in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

College Sophomore (2200 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C2-W-1, LeL-C2-LIT-1): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on choice in The Lady, or the Tiger? that reads the story against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Junior (2800 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C3-W-1, LeL-C3-LIT-1): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on choice in The Lady, or the Tiger?. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Senior (4000 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C4-W-1, LeL-C4-LIT-1): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about choice in The Lady, or the Tiger?, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Graduate / PhD (6000 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-GR-W-1, LeL-GR-LIT-1): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on choice in The Lady, or the Tiger?, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

Original Liber et Libri curriculum. Quotations from the public-domain text. Vocabulary definitions are modern and contextual (curated; based on Princeton WordNet 3.0). Word histories appear only where verified (Online Etymology Dictionary, 2026-10-20); other words are student look-ups. AP and Cambridge entries are our own summaries with links, not College Board or Cambridge text; ICC-WC and LeL IDs are Liber et Libri labels. Included with every curriculum purchase and with Classroom Pro.